YEARS 11 AND 12 / STAGE 6

# Work Studies

**THE GUIDED COURSE WORKBOOK**

Stage 6 Content Endorsed Course



**Read workplace evidence, test choices and build a useful record of learning across the current two-year course.**

**Name _____ Class _____ Teacher _____ Year ____**

A course illustration of pathway choices; it does not show an actual student or guarantee an outcome.

50 A4 pages · 25 double-sided sheets · Website-aligned learning companion

START HERE / CONTENTS AND LEARNING ROUTINE

# Your course companion

Follow the website's two-year sequence. Each module gives three connected readings with separate worked examples and compact applied tasks, then an extended-response and knowledge-check page.
Four paper labs connect application evidence, enterprise planning, cash flow and work-experience reflection.


| Course sequence | Student pages |
|---|---|
| Year 11: Core My Working Life | 3–6 |
| In the Workplace | 7–10 |
| Preparing Job Applications | 11–14 |
| Workplace Communication; evidence lab | 15–19 |
| Teamwork and Enterprise Skills | 20–23 |
| Team Enterprise Project; folio | 24–28 |
| Year 12: Work and Life Commitments | 29–32 |
| Personal Finance; cash-flow lab | 33–37 |
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| Experiencing Work; final folio | 46–50 |


## Use the paper space purposefully

Compact applied tasks fit in their ruled areas. The three source extended responses per module begin in the book; develop each to 120–180 words in your class folio labelled with the reading title, using the scaffold and current teacher-provided evidence when investigation is required. Explain links reasons to outcomes; evaluate weighs evidence and limitations before a justified judgement.

## Scope and current instructions

All 33 readings and 33 source extended-response prompts are retained. The paper book adapts 33 applied tasks and selects 11 of the website's 330 checks. The full 22-activity bank, 12 folio cards, detailed sources and media remain online. Stage 6 Content Endorsed Course: 240 indicative hours, 120 per year. Team Enterprise Project belongs in Year 11 before Work and Life Commitments.

Use current teacher notices for formal assessment, dates and submission. Current Year 12 assessment details are not inferred from historical material. Implementation, work experience and record collection require school and host approval. Use fictional or de-identified evidence; financial and legal examples require current official checks.

Source revision d4c57f2 • Print A4 duplex, long edge: 50 pages on 25 sheets.

Course:

stevencowell.github.io/Year-11-12-Work-Studies/

YEAR 11 / MY WORKING LIFE

# Work in contemporary Australia

Work is broader than a permanent paid job.
Paid employment arrangements include full-time, part-time, casual and contract work. Working life also includes self-employment, unpaid caring, volunteering, study-linked activity and contributions at home or in the community. A work environment combines its physical or digital setting, people and relationships, organisational purpose, expectations and task conditions. A transferable skill can be valuable in different settings. Contemporary working life also changes through interacting influences: technology redesigns tasks and roles; economic expansion or downturn affects vacancies, hours and security; laws, community expectations, global connections, demographic change and environmental pressures influence where and how work happens.

The labour market concerns worker supply and demand across occupations and places. Its trends describe broad patterns, not guaranteed personal outcomes. Evaluate it by asking what is changing, who is affected, what evidence supports the claim and which skills or pathways could help.
Education, training, experience and standard of living are connected, but no qualification automatically guarantees a particular lifestyle. Qualifications can open occupational pathways, while workplace and community experience can demonstrate transferable skills. Income supports housing, transport and further learning, yet pay alone cannot show whether work is satisfying or sustainable. Compare conditions, purpose, wellbeing, relationships, stability and learning opportunities alongside benefits, demands and possible next steps.



Figure 2. Source illustration. Work connects physical settings, digital tools and relationships. The image cannot establish conditions or employment arrangements.

### Worked example: Comparing three early work pathways

Mia compares a school-based traineeship, casual weekend retail work and regular volunteering at a community kitchen. She wants income, customer-service experience and a community-services pathway. Retail provides income and customer contact; the traineeship combines structured learning with work experience; volunteering can demonstrate reliability, teamwork and service without pay. Mia checks hours, training, supervision, travel and conditions before choosing. Combining options is reasonable only when total commitments are realistic, because no option automatically meets every goal.

**Apply the idea: Write three comparison notes for Mia, one per pathway. Name one benefit and one demand to check for each. Finish with one sentence explaining why income alone cannot decide her choice.**

YEAR 11 / MY WORKING LIFE

# Self-knowledge, pathways and career decisions

Self-assessment makes career decisions stronger by reviewing interests, values, attributes, skills and evidence. Interests describe what attracts attention; values explain what matters; personal attributes describe patterns of behaviour; skills identify capabilities; achievements provide evidence of performance. Categories overlap without being interchangeable; employability skills such as communication transfer across workplaces. “I am good with people” needs a situation, action, response and result before it becomes convincing evidence. A career pathway is a sequence of possible steps rather than a guaranteed ladder. It may include school subjects, vocational education and training, university, community learning, entry-level work, apprenticeships or traineeships, volunteering and later retraining. Several routes may develop similar capabilities while creating different demands and opportunities.

Compare pathways through entry requirements, time, cost, location, study mode, support, work conditions and what completion makes possible. Use current, reliable information and distinguish a formal requirement from a helpful preference. Career goals connect aspiration with action when they are clear, realistic and divided into smaller steps that produce monitorable evidence. Identify people who can advise, networks that reveal opportunities and resources that reduce barriers. A plan belongs to the learner, but facts should test it. Review progress as circumstances, interests or opportunities change. Revising a recommendation after learning more is responsible career management: it keeps action purposeful without pretending the first choice must remain suitable forever.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| self-assessment | a structured review of one’s interests, values, attributes, skills and evidence |
| career pathway | a possible sequence of learning, experience and work steps towards a career direction |

### Worked example: Turning an interest into a tested pathway

Jay enjoys digital design and has made school-event posters. He considers university, a vocational course and an entry-level print-shop role. His posters provide some design and communication evidence, but cannot prove every industry skill. Jay checks entry requirements, content, cost, travel and portfolio expectations. He improves a small portfolio, seeks feedback, compares two verified course sources and arranges an informational conversation. These steps test his interest while keeping several routes open and building useful evidence.

**Apply the idea: For Jay, write a three-step mini-plan: one piece of existing skill evidence, one pathway requirement to verify, and one action that addresses an evidence gap. Explain why his recommendation should remain revisable.**

YEAR 11 / MY WORKING LIFE

# Managing change and building a sustainable working life

Working lives involve transitions: starting work, changing hours or roles, learning technology, moving between study and employment, taking on caring responsibilities, leaving an employer and retiring. Some are chosen; others are imposed. Change can affect income, identity, routines, relationships and confidence together. Begin by naming the changes, gathering reliable information and separating what can be controlled, influenced or only responded to. Choose a safe, useful immediate action. Resilience means adapting through support, reflection and problem-solving. It can involve clarifying expectations, dividing problems into steps, seeking feedback, using personal or professional networks, updating skills, reviewing finances and accessing an appropriate support service.

People have different resources and responsibilities, so one strategy will not suit everyone. Personal agency matters, but workers should not be blamed for organisational or social conditions beyond their control. A sustainable working life protects health, relationships, legal responsibilities and essential recovery over time. Work–life balance is an ongoing judgement about commitments, boundaries, income, purpose, rest and support across a life stage; it is not an identical daily division of hours. Lifelong learning supports adaptability when it meets a real need through a feasible plan. Career management uses regular reviews to reveal progress or emerging strain, allowing a person to revise goals before temporary pressure becomes an unmanageable pattern.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| transition | a period of movement from one work, learning or life situation to another |
| resilience | the capacity to adapt, recover and keep acting purposefully while using appropriate support |

### Worked example: Responding to a major roster change

Leila faces a new roster and digital system. The roster clashes with a weekly caring responsibility, and she has not used the software. She separates the issues, checks confirmed arrangements and prepares a request to discuss the clash. For the software, she seeks training, practises one task at a time and records questions. Reviewing travel, rest and family support makes the transition more manageable. This combines communication, boundaries, learning and support without hiding difficulties or assuming Leila controls organisational decisions.

**Apply the idea: Write three labelled response notes for Leila: “Control”, “Influence” and “Outside her control”. Add one review question that tests whether her proposed response protects caring commitments, learning and recovery.**

YEAR 11 / MY WORKING LIFE

# Explain and check

Begin each source response below. Develop each into a 120–180-word explanation in your class folio, labelled with the reading title. Use the reading, its example and verified teacher-provided evidence where the prompt requires investigation.

**1. Evaluate how two major changes in contemporary Australia could affect the working life of a young person, then recommend a practical response.**

**2. Justify a career pathway recommendation for a fictional learner using both personal evidence and verified pathway information.**

**3. Evaluate a response to a major working-life transition and redesign it to be more sustainable.**

**Quick check: Jay discovers that one pathway requires a stronger portfolio. What is the best career-management response?**

- ○ A. Pretend the requirement does not exist
- ○ B. Abandon the whole career direction immediately
- ○ C. Add a portfolio-building step and keep comparing viable pathways
- ○ D. Submit copied work to fill the portfolio

YEAR 11 / IN THE WORKPLACE

# Structures, roles and relationships

Organisational structure arranges responsibility and authority. One person may perform several functions in a small organisation; larger workplaces may separate operations, finance, customer service, human resources and management. Organisational charts show formal reporting lines, but cooperation also crosses teams and involves internal customers, external customers and specialists. Knowing who can decide prevents duplication, delay and action beyond a worker's authority. A role describes a position's broad contribution; responsibilities are its particular duties and standards. Relationships connect people who coordinate, supervise, support, supply or serve one another. A new worker should clarify priorities, limits and escalation points rather than assume a familiar title explains everything.

Workplace protocols turn expectations into consistent actions: greeting customers, recording information, requesting assistance and attending meetings. Learn the actual workplace's process rather than borrow an unrelated procedure. Workplace arrangements also affect hours, supervision, continuity and responsibility.
These may include casual, part-time or full-time employment, apprenticeships or traineeships, contracts, labour-hire, voluntary work and self-employment. A label alone cannot establish all conditions; current authoritative information and actual documents are needed. A fair comparison considers organisational needs alongside the worker's income, learning, security, flexibility and future pathway. Structure therefore helps a worker recognise both what they must do and when another person's expertise or authority is needed.



Figure 3. Source illustration. A discussion connects roles and information. Visible cooperation does not establish permission to operate equipment.

### Worked example: Finding the right reporting path

Noah, a new café employee, notices an online order charged twice. The shift supervisor is serving customers and the owner is off-site. Noah checks the café's confirmed process, preserves the customer's information and informs whoever is currently authorised to resolve payment issues. He explains the facts without promising a refund beyond his role. Reporting shows responsibility, while leaving the financial decision to the authorised person respects the structure and immediate working relationships.

**Apply the idea: Write a three-part action note for Noah: the fact he must report, the authority he must check, and one promise he should avoid. Explain how this supports the customer without exceeding his role.**

YEAR 11 / IN THE WORKPLACE

# Rights, responsibilities and safe participation

Employment obligations are reciprocal. Employers provide lawful pay and conditions, safe, healthy systems, fair treatment and applicable duties. Employees contribute punctual attendance, conscientious and competent work, compliance with lawful and reasonable instructions, safe practice, anti-discrimination expectations and ethical conduct. Workers' safety duties do not remove employers' safe-system responsibilities. Legislation, awards, enterprise agreements and contracts may shape conditions. Awards set minimum pay and conditions for covered work; enterprise agreements set approved enterprise or group conditions. Relevant sources depend on the situation. Read actual documents, keep records and check current official information with support from a trusted adult, representative or official service. Course materials cannot determine exact pay, leave, trial periods, dismissal or entitlements.

A safe system organises work to control identified risks. Participation includes noticing hazards, following confirmed controls, using equipment only as authorised and asking before continuing unsafe or unclear work. Psychological and social safety matter too: bullying, harassment and discrimination harm people and work. Discrimination concerns unfair treatment linked to a protected personal characteristic under applicable law. Record facts, avoid retaliation or public accusation, follow the confirmed reporting path and seek appropriate support. Local procedures require current workplace and authoritative guidance. Ask a teacher or trusted adult to help locate them rather than improvise legal or emergency instructions. Safe participation depends on both organisational systems and responsible worker action.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| employment obligation | a duty arising from the employment relationship and its applicable rules |
| award | a legal instrument setting minimum pay and conditions for covered work |

### Worked example: An unclear instruction

A supervisor asks Priya to use unfamiliar equipment while the usual trained worker is absent. She has not been shown the task and is unsure of its controls. Priya pauses, explains her training limits and seeks clarification through the confirmed workplace pathway. She follows immediate safety directions and records relevant facts. Her responsibility to work safely operates alongside the employer's responsibility for safe systems; the course cannot decide the equipment's exact authorisation or local procedure.

**Apply the idea: Write Priya's two-sentence clarification script, then name one employer responsibility and one employee responsibility it addresses. Keep the script factual and leave equipment authorisation to the confirmed workplace process.**

YEAR 11 / IN THE WORKPLACE

# Workplace culture, performance and change

Workplace culture grows through leadership, systems and repeated interactions. Look at communication, inclusion, treatment of customers, information sharing, pressure and responses to mistakes. Actions, incentives and decisions show whether values are applied consistently; a slogan alone cannot prove culture. Culture influences belonging, ethics, learning, teamwork and willingness to raise concerns. Performance also means more than speed. Performance indicators measure quantity, quality, customer and supervisor expectations, safety, reliability, self-management, teamwork, initiative, technology use and progress towards goals. Indicators may conflict: faster output can conceal poorer quality. Fair discussion uses communicated expectations, relevant work evidence and feedback that identifies strengths and achievable next steps.

One observation should not define someone's entire capability. Changes may involve technology, processes, team structures, regulations or customer needs. Workers can clarify the purpose, identify what remains unchanged, learn the new requirement, seek assistance and monitor results. Constructive feedback is specific, focuses on behaviour or work and connects to feasible improvement. Giving feedback respectfully is as important as receiving it. Managing change productively allows evidence-based questions through appropriate pathways; it does not require unquestioning acceptance. Continuous improvement uses evidence and review. Balanced evaluation asks whether results improved across relevant indicators and whether the response to difficulties helped people learn, coordinate and raise problems without hiding them.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| workplace culture | the shared patterns of behaviour and expectations that shape everyday work |
| performance indicator | a defined sign or measure used to judge progress or work quality |

### Worked example: Quality falls after a rushed change

A delivery team introduces scheduling software. Output rises for one week, but incorrect addresses and customer complaints increase too. The review checks errors, training, workload, customer feedback and quality, rather than celebrating delivery numbers alone. Workers understood booking but not address validation. A short practice session, a clearer checking step and review after another week target this gap. Mistakes become evidence for improvement, while several indicators reveal whether the change really supports performance.

**Apply the idea: Write a four-indicator review note for the delivery team, including output and quality. Add one constructive feedback sentence that identifies the address-validation gap and a feasible improvement rather than blaming workers.**

YEAR 11 / IN THE WORKPLACE

# Explain and check

Begin each source response below. Develop each into a 120–180-word explanation in your class folio, labelled with the reading title. Use the reading, its example and verified teacher-provided evidence where the prompt requires investigation.

**1. Apply a workplace structure to resolve a coordination problem involving two teams and a customer.**

**2. Evaluate a fictional workplace concern and justify a safe, fair next response without giving legal advice.**

**3. Evaluate whether a workplace change has improved performance and culture, then recommend a next step.**

**Quick check: Which set of indicators gives the most balanced view of a service team?**

- ○ A. Number of tasks only
- ○ B. The manager’s mood
- ○ C. How long workers remain at their desks
- ○ D. Timeliness, accuracy, safe practice, customer response and teamwork

YEAR 11 / PREPARING JOB APPLICATIONS

# Reading opportunities and selection criteria

Opportunities appear through employer websites, job platforms, agencies, careers services and community networks, or through the hidden job market of contacts, experience and recommendations. An advertisement is a starting source, not a complete picture of the workplace. Identify role purpose, duties, location, hours, employment arrangement, required qualifications or licences, application method and closing information. Research the employer through reliable sources so the application addresses the actual organisation. A selection criterion describes a capability, qualification or attribute used to judge applicants. Distinguish essential requirements, desirable requirements and role descriptions by reading the wording and instructions carefully. Unpack a criterion into its action and context before deciding which evidence demonstrates it.

For example, effective customer communication needs an account of audience, purpose, action and outcome, not merely “good communication”. Match honestly and identify gaps: a missing desirable skill may be manageable, while a mandatory qualification cannot be disguised. Job suitability works both ways. Employers judge potential contribution; applicants compare the work with their preferences, values, qualifications, travel, conditions, wellbeing and longer-term goals. Labour-market information gives context but cannot decide the outcome of one vacancy. Use the best available evidence, separate known facts from questions and clarify uncertainties. An applicant need not reject an opportunity simply because they lack every non-essential preference, but should still test eligibility and sustainable participation.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| selection criterion | a capability, qualification or attribute used to assess applicants |
| essential requirement | a condition an applicant must meet to be eligible or perform the role |

### Worked example: Unpacking a customer-service vacancy

A vacancy requires reliable attendance, clear customer communication, basic digital confidence and weekend availability; retail experience is desirable. Asha matches reliability to a school-event role, communication to volunteering and digital confidence to a booking task. She has no retail experience and does not claim it. Instead, she explains transferable evidence and checks travel and whether weekend work is sustainable. Applying is a reasoned possibility because she distinguishes main requirements from a desirable preference.

**Apply the idea: Write two criterion–evidence matches for Asha. Then identify her desirable-skill gap and one condition she must clarify before applying. Finish with an apply-or-clarify judgement supported by the printed example.**

YEAR 11 / PREPARING JOB APPLICATIONS

# Building evidence-based applications

An application makes an evidence argument: identify employer needs, choose truthful examples and show the connection. Evidence may come from school, paid work, workplace learning, volunteering, sport, community activity, caring or enterprise. An evidence statement describes the situation, task or goal, action and result. Accurate numbers can help, but relevant detail matters more than decoration. Never copy someone else's achievement or turn participation into a responsibility you did not hold. A résumé records relevant skills, education, experience and achievements clearly. A covering letter identifies the vacancy, introduces the application and highlights the strongest match. Both documents should be tailored, concise and consistent with each other.

Referees need relevant knowledge of behaviour or performance and must have agreed to be contacted. Use fictional details in public learning activities; real addresses, phone numbers and private referee information do not belong on a public course site. Quality control demonstrates employability. Follow file-type and naming instructions, check dates and contact details, use proofreading to check spelling and layout, verify criterion matches and confirm attachments open. Technology may assist drafting, but accuracy, authorship and tone remain the applicant's responsibility. Read from the employer's perspective: is relevant evidence easy to locate, does it answer this vacancy, and can every claim be defended? Strong applications make useful evidence accessible without exaggeration.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| résumé | a concise record of relevant skills, education, experience and achievements for an application |
| covering letter | a tailored introduction that connects an applicant's strongest evidence to a specific opportunity |

### Worked example: From duty list to achievement evidence

For an event-assistant role, Luca writes, "Helped at the school fundraiser." He checks his actual contribution and revises it: "Coordinated the sign-in table with two volunteers, answered visitor questions and reconciled attendance numbers at closing." This gives evidence of communication, teamwork, organisation and accurate recording without claiming unsupported leadership or financial responsibility. His covering letter then explains the connection to the vacancy's event-support criterion, helping the employer see why the example matters.

**Apply the idea: Use Luca's example to write one evidence statement suited to event support and one sentence linking it to the vacancy. Add two submission checks that protect accuracy, relevance or privacy.**

YEAR 11 / PREPARING JOB APPLICATIONS

# Interview preparation, performance and reflection

Interview preparation starts with the vacancy and submitted application. Revisit criteria, research the organisation, prepare truthful examples and plan time, access, technology and requested documents. Prepare interview evidence for behavioural questions about past actions using context, task or goal, action and result. This creates flexible material that answers the actual question, rather than a memorised speech. During the interview, greet appropriately, listen to the whole question, ask a clarifying question about uncertainty and give relevant detail. Voice and pace support meaning; non-verbal communication includes posture, facial expression and eye contact, but expectations vary with people, culture and disability. Professional communication should be respectful and accessible; capability is not demonstrated by copying one narrow style or stereotype.

An interview exchanges information in both directions. Thoughtful questions can clarify duties, support, learning and next steps, while avoiding requests for information already supplied. Afterwards, record the questions, judge which examples worked, identify gaps and seek feedback when available. Evaluate preparation, listening and responses using observable evidence rather than assumptions about the employer's decision. An interview outcome does not measure a person's worth. Reflection turns one performance into preparation for another opportunity: strengthen relevant examples, improve practical arrangements and choose specific changes. The aim is a clearer, more flexible account of capability, while keeping claims about yourself, the employer and the selection outcome evidence-based.



Figure 4. Source illustration. A simulated interview can support feedback. Recording still requires permission; use fictional practice evidence.

### Worked example: Repairing a vague interview answer

Asked about teamwork, Erin says, "I work well with anyone," then stops. She adds an example: conflicting group availability led her to create a shared schedule, check everyone's constraints and move one deadline by agreement. The group completed the task on time. This shows listening, organisation, negotiation and an outcome, rather than an unsupported claim. Afterwards, Erin decides that preparing two flexible examples would help her answer future questions with relevant evidence.

**Apply the idea: Write Erin's revised teamwork answer in two or three sentences using context, action and result. Add one reflection note explaining how preparing flexible examples improves a future interview response.**

YEAR 11 / PREPARING JOB APPLICATIONS

# Explain and check

Begin each source response below. Develop each into a 120–180-word explanation in your class folio, labelled with the reading title. Use the reading, its example and verified teacher-provided evidence where the prompt requires investigation.

**1. Evaluate whether a fictional applicant should pursue a vacancy and justify the decision using the advertisement and the applicant's evidence.**

**2. Justify how a fictional applicant should select and present evidence for a specific vacancy.**

**3. Evaluate a fictional interview performance and design a stronger preparation and response strategy.**

**Quick check: A criterion says 'works effectively in a team'. What is the strongest matching evidence?**

- ○ A. A specific example showing the team goal, the applicant's action and the result
- ○ B. The sentence 'I love teamwork'
- ○ C. A definition copied from a website
- ○ D. A list of team members' names

YEAR 11 / WORKPLACE COMMUNICATION

# Purpose, audience and communication channels

Communication can inform, instruct, request, confirm, persuade, record, warn, solve a problem or build a relationship. Audience knowledge, authority, language, culture and access needs affect what a message requires. Decide what receivers need to know, what they should do and what evidence or record is necessary. Sending is not proof of understanding.
Communication channels include face-to-face discussion, telephone or video, email, messaging, forms, reports, diagrams, numerical records and presentations. Spoken channels permit quick questions but may leave no record. Writing can be checked and retained, yet may be too slow for an immediate hazard. Visual and numerical forms clarify patterns or spatial relationships when accurate.

Choose channels by urgency, complexity, confidentiality, accessibility and the need for confirmation. Meaning also depends on the receiver. Active listening includes attention, relevant questions, paraphrasing and checking instructions rather than waiting to speak. Open questions invite detail; closed questions confirm a fact. Technical information may need definitions, diagrams or demonstration, with accurate labels and values. Share confidential information only through authorised channels with people who need it for their role. Across cultures or abilities, respectful checking is more reliable than assuming what someone should understand. A communication plan can combine channels, provided the immediate message, later record and confirmation each serve a clear purpose.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| audience | the person or group for whom a message is designed |
| communication channel | the medium used to send or receive a message |

### Worked example: Choosing a channel for a delivery problem

A driver finds that a delivery address conflicts with the order record. The customer is waiting, and any correction needs documentation. The driver contacts the relevant coordinator through an immediate authorised channel, states the conflicting facts and asks a closed question to confirm the correct address. After the decision, the change is recorded in the system. This combines speed and an accurate record while keeping customer information within the approved process.

**Apply the idea: Write the driver’s communication plan in three steps: immediate contact, confirmation and record. Add one reason this combination is stronger than a written message alone while the customer is waiting.**

YEAR 11 / WORKPLACE COMMUNICATION

# Professional spoken, written and digital communication

Professional communication is clear, concise, correct, courteous and workplace-appropriate. Spoken messages need audible pace, relevant detail and listening. Writing uses a useful subject, logical order, accurate spelling and punctuation, and a clear action. Numerical or visual information needs correct units, labels and calculations. Plain language makes meaning direct rather than complicated. Professional tone expresses the relationship: customer, colleague and supervisor messages may differ in detail and formality, but need honesty and respect. Personal presentation, body language and space affect reception, with cultural and individual differences requiring care. Accessibility means people with differing needs can perceive and use the message through suitable formats or alternatives.

Avoid excluding people through jokes, slang or assumptions. Digital tools support email, scheduling, documents, spreadsheets, databases, presentations, research and transactions. Netiquette means respectful, responsible digital behaviour. Follow workplace policy, protect accounts and confidential information, check recipients and attachments, and separate personal activity from authorised work. A digital footprint is the lasting record of online actions and content. Social media, personal devices and generative tools leave accuracy, privacy and authorship with the worker. Review slowly if forwarding or misunderstanding could cause harm. Check that the audience can understand and act, and that necessary details are accurate and authorised. Clear wording cannot compensate for incorrect or private information.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| professional tone | a respectful and purpose-appropriate manner of communication |
| plain language | clear, direct wording designed to be understood by its intended audience |

### Worked example: Rewriting an unclear shift email

An email says, “Roster changed. You know what to do,” but omits the date, affected shifts and contact point. The improved message uses a specific subject, states the confirmed commencement, directs staff to the confirmed roster, identifies who must respond and gives the authorised contact for questions. It excludes unnecessary personal information. This makes the change actionable and creates a reliable record, while leaving the actual roster decision with the workplace.

**Apply the idea: Design a four-item editing checklist for the unclear roster email. Cover the missing action details, one privacy check and one access check. Name what must be confirmed rather than inventing roster information.**

YEAR 11 / WORKPLACE COMMUNICATION

# Feedback, conflict and communication repair

Different roles, information, priorities and communication styles create risks of disagreement or misunderstanding. Separate the issue from personal attack. A position is what someone says they want; an interest is the underlying need or concern. Checking facts, listening actively and finding shared goals can reveal options beyond fixed demands. Constructive feedback describes observable behaviour or work, its effect and a practical next step. The receiver listens, asks questions, checks examples and decides on action rather than reacting only to tone. Professional reception does not require automatic agreement: inaccurate or poorly delivered feedback can be tested against evidence, clarified expectations and an appropriate review pathway.

Communication repair acknowledges misunderstanding, corrects the record, checks impact and confirms the next action. Negotiation can involve priorities, common ground, options, concessions and confirmation. A checkable agreement makes responsibilities visible instead of relying on assumptions. Some issues suit informal resolution, while repeated, unsafe, discriminatory or serious concerns may require formal support or escalation. The exact process must come from the current workplace and authoritative guidance. Ask a teacher or trusted adult to help locate it; document facts and seek appropriate help rather than inventing mediation, disciplinary or legal procedures. Successful repair addresses both immediate effects and the communication system that allowed the problem.



Figure 5. Source illustration. A face-to-face discussion offers immediate feedback. Privacy, purpose and the people involved affect the suitable channel.

### Worked example: Repairing a missed handover

Sam thinks Kai will finish a customer update; Kai thinks Sam accepted it. The customer receives no response. They state what each understood, check the handover record and identify missing confirmation instead of blaming each other. Through the authorised channel, they apologise, allocate the immediate task and add closed-loop handover: the sender names task and deadline, the receiver confirms, and both can see the record. This repairs the customer impact and the system.

**Apply the idea: Write a three-line closed-loop handover for Sam and Kai: sender's task message, receiver's confirmation and shared record note. Finish with one sentence explaining how this repairs the cause of the missed update.**

YEAR 11 / WORKPLACE COMMUNICATION

# Explain and check

Begin each source response below. Develop each into a 120–180-word explanation in your class folio, labelled with the reading title. Use the reading, its example and verified teacher-provided evidence where the prompt requires investigation.

**1. Justify a communication plan for a complex workplace situation involving urgency, confidentiality and different audiences.**

**2. Compare two versions of a workplace message and justify a final version for a specific audience and digital channel.**

**3. Evaluate a workplace conflict response and design a communication repair and escalation plan.**

**Quick check: Which feedback is most constructive?**

- ○ A. You are hopeless
- ○ B. Everything was fine
- ○ C. The stock count was missing two items; use the checklist and ask me to review the next count
- ○ D. Remember every mistake anyone has made

YEAR 11 / APPLICATION AND COMMUNICATION LAB

# From criterion to convincing evidence

A strong application traces a requirement to evidence. A context explains where the experience occurred; an action names what the person actually did; a result reports what happened without inventing success. The final link explains why that evidence matters for this vacancy. A duty list alone does not show capability.

### Source example: Luca's event evidence

The original claim is "Helped at the school fundraiser". Luca checks his contribution and rewrites it: "Coordinated the sign-in table with two volunteers, answered visitor questions and reconciled attendance numbers at closing." The evidence supports organisation, teamwork, communication and accurate records. It does not prove financial responsibility or leadership of the whole event.

| Context | Action | Result or evidence | Relevant criterion |
|---|---|---|---|
| School fundraiser | Sign-in with two volunteers; visitor questions | Attendance numbers reconciled at closing | Event support; accurate records |

## Build a precise evidence chain

Fictional practice brief: an event-assistant vacancy asks for clear communication, reliable teamwork and accurate records. Use Luca's checked example; do not invent a new achievement.

| Criterion | Evidence from Luca | What remains unverified? |
|---|---|---|
| Clear communication | | |
| Reliable teamwork | | |
| Accurate records | | |

**Draft a four-sentence covering-letter paragraph. Connect the selected evidence to the fictional vacancy, then state one fact you would check before submitting.**

YEAR 11 / TEAMWORK AND ENTERPRISE SKILLS

# Team roles, trust and shared goals

A team coordinates different contributions towards a shared goal, with members jointly affected by the result. Team roles may cover leadership, planning, specialist work, communication, checking or support, and can change during a project. Allocate them using task needs, capability, development, workload and accountability rather than stereotypes about age, gender, culture or personality. Trust grows through reliability, honest communication, kept commitments, admitted uncertainty, protected agreed information and respectful treatment. Psychological safety allows appropriate questions and early reporting of mistakes; it does not remove standards or accountability. A shared goal needs agreed results, indicators, responsibilities, decision processes and deadlines, not an expectation held privately by one member.

Active listening, clear records, inclusive meetings and constructive feedback coordinate the work. Disagreement can improve decisions when people challenge ideas with evidence and remain focused on the goal. If contribution appears uneven, establish facts, clarify expectations and review tasks before making personal judgements. Fairness does not require everyone to perform identical work; different contributions can be balanced through visible ownership and appropriate support. Monitor both product and process: what has been achieved, which work is blocked, what needs changing and what each person is learning. Regular review helps the team adjust responsibility without treating every problem as a failure of character or commitment.



Figure 6. Source illustration. Shared physical tasks depend on roles and coordination. This contextual image is not a safe assembly procedure.

### Worked example: Rebalancing a stalled event team

A four-person event team finds that two members duplicate publicity while bookings and risk questions remain untouched. They return to the shared goal, list remaining outputs and check each person’s capacity. Each task receives one owner and one check point; dependencies are recorded and a brief review is scheduled. This makes responsibility visible and reduces duplication without punishing individuals. Members can still support one another, while everyone knows who owns each output.

**Apply the idea: Create three task-map notes for publicity, bookings and risk questions. For each, name an owner role and a check point. Add one fairness rule the four-person team should use when allocating work.**

YEAR 11 / TEAMWORK AND ENTERPRISE SKILLS

# Initiative, problem-solving and decision-making

Problem-solving identifies the gap between the current and desired situation. A symptom may not reveal its cause: late orders could reflect unclear information, unrealistic scheduling, supplies or interacting factors. A problem definition identifies who is affected, evidence, constraints and the desired result. Gather enough information to act without pretending every uncertainty can disappear. Decision criteria compare options using effectiveness, time, cost, safety, fairness, resources, authority and likely side effects. A decision matrix makes comparisons visible, but scores cannot replace judgement: chosen criteria and weightings need justification. Monitoring checks relevant indicators after action and supports adjustment. Even an unsuccessful idea can teach something when assumptions and results are recorded honestly.

Initiative is appropriate independent action within the worker's role and the situation's risk. It can mean anticipating a need, suggesting improvements, gathering information or completing an agreed step without repeated reminders. It does not permit bypassing safety controls, privacy, budgets or another person's responsibility. High uncertainty or impact makes clarification and escalation part of good judgement. A useful recommendation therefore explains not only what to try, but why it addresses the likely cause, which permission limits apply and how results will be checked. This separates purposeful problem-solving from acting quickly on blame, guesswork or an attractive solution that fails to meet the actual need.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| problem definition | a clear statement of the current gap, evidence, people affected and desired result |
| constraint | a limit or condition that a solution must respect |

### Worked example: Solving repeated late starts

A student enterprise team starts production late every session and initially blames motivation. Observation shows that tools, instructions and materials are collected after the session begins. Options include a pre-session checklist, an assigned setup role and staged materials. The team chooses a checklist with a rotating owner, measures start times for three sessions and reviews. This addresses the unprepared start process without treating it as a character flaw or bypassing equipment and safety authorisation.

**Apply the idea: Write the team's problem statement without blaming motivation. Compare checklist and staged materials using one shared criterion, then name the three-session indicator and one authority limit that must remain in place.**

YEAR 11 / TEAMWORK AND ENTERPRISE SKILLS

# Enterprise skills in authentic work

Enterprise identifies an opportunity or need and organises action that creates financial, social, environmental or educational value. Skills include initiative, creativity, communication, teamwork, planning, resourcefulness, calculated risk, resilience and reflection. Employees and community members use them as well as business owners. An idea becomes enterprising through investigation, responsible planning and action. Start with stakeholder evidence: who experiences the need, what already exists, which constraints apply and what success means. Teams set goals, targets and deadlines, allocate resources, obtain required authority, communicate, monitor progress and respond to issues. Innovation may be a new product, service or process, or a thoughtful improvement to an existing approach.

Risk should be calculated rather than celebrated. Identify possible harms or losses, consider likelihood and impact, apply controls and judge remaining risk within the relevant authority. Potential return does not justify ignoring safety or other constraints. Evaluation considers outcome quality alongside development of enterprise skills, so the largest output is not automatically the greatest value. Useful indicators connect directly to the evidenced need and intended benefit. Record what failed and why, as well as successes. Honest reflection helps people transfer learning to employment, later projects and community action. A small, feasible improvement can demonstrate stronger enterprise than an ambitious idea that cannot responsibly meet its purpose.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| enterprise | organised action that responds to an opportunity or need and creates value |
| stakeholder | a person or group affected by or able to influence an activity |

### Worked example: Improving a community collection

A school collection receives unsuitable items, leaving volunteers hours of sorting. A team consults the receiving organisation, identifies needed items and introduces a clear list, labelled collection points and a weekly count. School approval precedes launch, with communication and monitoring roles assigned. The team compares unsuitable-item rates rather than celebrating volume alone. Its value lies in reducing waste and meeting an evidenced community need; the redesigned process turns stakeholder information into purposeful action.

**Apply the idea: Write a four-part mini-brief for the collection: evidenced need, proposed process improvement, required authority and one success indicator. Add one sentence explaining why collection volume alone would be a weak measure.**

YEAR 11 / TEAMWORK AND ENTERPRISE SKILLS

# Explain and check

Begin each source response below. Develop each into a 120–180-word explanation in your class folio, labelled with the reading title. Use the reading, its example and verified teacher-provided evidence where the prompt requires investigation.

**1. Evaluate the effectiveness and fairness of a fictional team, then redesign its roles and trust practices.**

**2. Apply a problem-solving process to a workplace scenario and justify the point at which initiative should become escalation.**

**3. Evaluate a proposed enterprise response to a community or workplace need and recommend whether it should proceed to authorised planning.**

**Quick check: What makes monitoring useful?**

- ○ A. An agreed indicator, timeframe and decision about what results will trigger review
- ○ B. Collecting unrelated data forever
- ○ C. Changing the goal after every result
- ○ D. Recording only successes

YEAR 11 / TEAM ENTERPRISE PROJECT

# Defining the problem and project purpose

A team enterprise project applies skills to workplace-like situations: a good, service, event, simulated business, community initiative or school support. Possibility is not approval. Project choice, external contact, identity use, money, facilities, data and safety follow the teacher's current instructions. Until implementation is explicitly approved, use a planning-only simulation with fictional stakeholders and costs. Begin with a problem statement: who experiences what need, in which context, and what evidence shows its importance? Starting with a favourite solution risks solution fixation. Interviews, observations, records or small tests can clarify the need only within approval and privacy boundaries. Purpose describes intended useful change without claiming unobserved success.

Scope sets inclusions, exclusions, time, resources, decision authority and constraints so work remains manageable. Goals identify intended results; indicators identify evidence of progress or achievement. Both product or service effects and learning outcomes matter. Compare alternative responses before choosing a deliverable, using the need, resources, constraints and likely impact rather than enthusiasm alone. A coherent proposal connects problem, purpose, deliverable, stakeholders, scope, resources, risks, indicators and approval gates. It should also identify evidence or changed conditions that would require revision or rejection. Clear boundaries support responsible planning without turning a classroom proposal into permission to contact others, collect data or launch an enterprise.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| problem statement | an evidence-based description of who experiences a need, what occurs and in which context |
| scope | the agreed boundaries of what a project includes, excludes and is authorised to do |

### Worked example: Scoping a reusable-resource initiative

A team wants to "fix waste at school" by selling reusable kits, but has collected no waste evidence and has no sales approval. It narrows the need to hypothetical disposable-item use at one event, identifies users and organisers, and proposes an approved audit or simulated dataset. Kit, communication and process-change options are compared. A small deliverable, exclusions, indicators and approval gates keep the project bounded and planning-only unless the teacher confirms implementation.

**Apply the idea: Rewrite the team's broad claim as a bounded hypothetical problem statement. Name one alternative to selling kits, one indicator to test the need, and one approval dependency. Keep your proposal planning-only.**

YEAR 11 / TEAM ENTERPRISE PROJECT

# Roles, resources, risks and communication

Team planning turns a proposal into coordinated action. Allocate visible roles using capability, learning goals, availability and workload, with backups for critical tasks and shared information. Responsibility means owning the next action and reporting evidence; accountability remains shared when decisions affect the team. Meeting records capture decisions, actions, owners and due dates rather than every spoken word. Action plans sequence tasks and show dependencies: work or approval that must finish before something else starts. Milestones mark meaningful progress. Resource registers track people, time, materials, equipment, information and approved funds, including contingency estimates and actual use. Busyness cannot compensate for unmanaged critical dependencies or shared resources.

Review safety, financial, operational, privacy, reputational and participation risks continuously as conditions change. Communication also needs ongoing attention, matched to audience and purpose. Change control uses a request stating the proposed alteration, its reason, its effects on scope, time, resources and risk, and who may approve it. Resolve disagreement through evidence, shared goals and agreed decision rules rather than dominance or blame. Update connected controls together: a reduced deliverable may change milestones, resource needs, messages and risks. Monitor ownership and progress fairly, including blocked work and evidence gaps. All local tools, contacts and authorisation levels must follow current teacher instructions, even when a recovery plan seems urgent.



Figure 7. Source illustration. A team planning table links people, resources and dependencies. Attractive plans alone do not show delivery.

### Worked example: Recovering a slipping event simulation

A simulated careers-event team has promotion drafts but no confirmed session plan. The venue task depends on teacher approval, and one member holds all stakeholder notes. The team maps dependencies, pauses claims based on unconfirmed details and moves notes to an approved shared location. Critical tasks gain one owner and backup, allocated by workload and capability. A change request reduces scope and updates milestones, risks and messages, targeting the bottleneck rather than blaming appearances.

**Apply the idea: Write a three-step recovery note for the simulated event: one blocked dependency, one ownership-and-backup change, and one linked control to update. Explain why promotion claims must wait for confirmed information.**

YEAR 11 / TEAM ENTERPRISE PROJECT

# Delivering, evaluating and presenting enterprise evidence

Delivery is controlled implementation, with monitoring of quality, schedule, resources, participation and risk and records of decisions or changes. Evidence may include approved observations, counts, feedback, version history, meeting actions and product checks. Collect proportionate, privacy-safe evidence aligned with indicators: greater quantity cannot repair irrelevant, inconsistent or unauthorised material. Evaluation compares intention with what occurred and explains why. Outcome evidence examines deliverable effects; process evidence examines planning, communication and problem-solving; learning evidence shows growth in teamwork and enterprise skills. Be cautious about attribution: improvement after a project does not prove it caused every change. Include limitations, unexpected effects and stakeholder differences in the judgement.

Presentations should reveal reasoning from need and purpose through proposal, implementation, adaptations, evidence, evaluation and next steps. Match claims to evidence strength, and analyse setbacks rather than hide them. For a simulation, distinguish planned or fictional results from actual implementation. Individual reflection identifies a specific contribution, relevant feedback, learning and transfer to future work. Approved public-safe artefacts may illustrate the story, but exclude personal data, unapproved images, private messages and fabricated testimonials. A justified next step follows the evaluation: revise a weak feature, gather better authorised evidence or seek approval where appropriate. Presentation quality supports the argument; it cannot replace credible outcome, process and learning evidence.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| baseline | the starting evidence used to compare later change or performance |
| attribution | a judgement about how much a project contributed to an observed result |

### Worked example: Evaluating a simulated orientation resource

A team creates a prototype orientation guide. Five test users find information faster, but two pages remain confusing and only one test group participates. The team compares time and feedback with its baseline, acknowledges the small sample and shows page-redesign versions. It cannot claim success for every user or permission for public release. Each member links a contribution and feedback to a transferable work skill, making the evaluation stronger than a polished success claim alone.

**Apply the idea: Write three labelled evidence notes for the prototype: “Outcome”, “Process” and “Learning”. Add one limitation and one justified next step. Use the five-user test without claiming it represents every user.**

YEAR 11 / TEAM ENTERPRISE PROJECT

# Explain and check

Begin each source response below. Develop each into a 120–180-word explanation in your class folio, labelled with the reading title. Use the reading, its example and verified teacher-provided evidence where the prompt requires investigation.

**1. Evaluate three possible enterprise responses to a verified need and justify a bounded project proposal.**

**2. Evaluate a slipping team enterprise project and redesign its coordination system to recover the most important outcomes.**

**3. Evaluate a team enterprise project using outcome, process and learning evidence, then propose a justified next step.**

**Quick check: Which evidence best shows project process?**

- ○ A. A final slogan alone
- ○ B. An unrelated industry statistic
- ○ C. An unsupported claim that teamwork was good
- ○ D. Dated meeting actions and versions showing how the team responded to a problem

YEAR 11 / TEAM ENTERPRISE FOLIO

# Plan a bounded team enterprise

Source scenario: a team wants to reduce disposable items at a school event, but has collected no waste evidence and has no approval to sell reusable kits. Keep the project planning-only. Compare possible responses before committing, and separate a desired outcome from evidence that it has happened.

| Possible response | Evidence or resource needed | Approval or limitation |
|---|---|---|
| Reusable-kit proposal | | |
| Information resource | | |
| Change to event process | | |

**Write a bounded problem statement, one small deliverable and two exclusions. Identify the users or organisers who would need to be consulted through an approved process.**

| Critical task / dependency | Owner and backup | Milestone / approval gate |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | | |
| 2 | | |
| 3 | | |

**Set three measurable indicators and one review question. Explain how you would report a result honestly if only one small test group supplied evidence.**

Planning evidence is formative learning. It is not permission to sell, collect data, spend money, publish or implement an event.

YEAR 12 / MANAGING WORK AND LIFE COMMITMENTS

# Time, priorities and realistic boundaries

A commitment uses more than the time shown beside an appointment. Preparation, travel, transitions, caring, study, sleep and recovery all draw on limited capacity: time, energy, attention and money. A priority is ranked by importance, urgency or consequence, rather than by how loudly someone requests it. Fixed responsibilities differ from flexible or discretionary activities. Planning makes these distinctions visible before overload causes missed work or rushed study. A calendar locates fixed events, a task list identifies actions, and realistic estimates reveal the full demand. Divide a large task into a clear next action and milestones, leaving buffer time for delays and uncertainty.

Review points help detect pressure early and test whether the plan remains workable. A digital calendar is useful only if it supports decisions; filling every space does not create extra capacity. Boundaries communicate what can reasonably be done and when. Raise a clash early, respectfully, and with a feasible alternative where possible. Some obligations cannot simply be moved, so the response may involve clarifying priorities, adjusting discretionary activities or seeking support. Leave, roster and deadline changes depend on the current confirmed process; do not assume permission. Check authoritative workplace information with a teacher or trusted adult where needed. Good time management includes declining, renegotiating or sequencing requests, while protecting essential responsibilities and recovery.



Figure 8. Source illustration. A commitments map can reveal clashes between work and life. Planning categories need to fit the person’s situation.

### Worked example: The hidden hours in a crowded week

Tariq accepts three evening shifts, a major school task and weekend family responsibilities. His calendar omits travel, preparation and rest. Adding those hidden demands reveals an impossible Thursday. He protects the fixed assessment preparation and family commitment, checks the actual shift arrangement and communicates the clash early through the confirmed channel. Removing a discretionary event creates room without pretending every obligation can move. A Sunday review checks whether the revised plan matches capacity rather than optimism.

**Apply the idea: Use Tariq's example to identify two hidden time demands, one essential commitment and one discretionary change. Write a respectful boundary sentence that requests clarification without assuming his shift can be changed.**

YEAR 12 / MANAGING WORK AND LIFE COMMITMENTS

# Wellbeing, stress and support

Work can provide income, purpose, learning, connection and satisfaction, while workload, conflict, uncertainty, rosters, travel and competing responsibilities create pressure. Stress is a response to demands and available resources, rather than evidence of weakness. Brief pressure may be manageable, but repeated or intense strain can affect concentration, sleep, relationships and safe performance. Describe observable signs and their context without diagnosing a person from a checklist. Protective factors, such as reliable support, recovery time and clear expectations, can reduce risk. A useful analysis asks what is happening, how it affects the person and which resources or workplace changes might help.

Self-management includes clarifying priorities, planning tasks, taking lawful breaks, recovering and seeking feedback or training. These actions cannot excuse unsafe systems, bullying, discrimination or unreasonable demands. Wellbeing reflects interacting personal, organisational and social influences; responsibility does not rest solely with the individual. Support might involve a trusted person, school staff, an appropriate supervisor or workplace representative, or a qualified health professional. Match the response to urgency, safety, privacy and needs. Immediate danger or a serious health concern requires appropriate emergency or professional help, rather than a classroom activity. Use current confirmed school, workplace or service pathways, asking a teacher or trusted adult to help locate guidance. Early help-seeking and factual records can make the explanation of impact clearer.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| wellbeing | a person’s capacity to function and experience physical, mental and social health |
| stress response | the physical, emotional or cognitive reaction to perceived demands |

### Worked example: From silent overload to supported action

Amelia makes frequent errors after roster changes and caring demands. She believes asking for help would prove unreliability. Instead of diagnosing herself, she records the pattern and checks immediate safety. She explains the roster and caring clash to an appropriate trusted person through the confirmed process, asks for priorities to be clarified and seeks support for the broader strain. Planning may help, but the response also examines work conditions and does not assign all responsibility to Amelia.

**Apply the idea: For Amelia, distinguish one observable effect from an unsupported diagnosis. Suggest one personal strategy and one workplace question, then identify why the seriousness of the situation must guide support choices.**

YEAR 12 / MANAGING WORK AND LIFE COMMITMENTS

# Adapting plans across changing life stages

Working lives change as study, housing, relationships, caring, health, finances and community responsibilities change. A life stage describes current roles, resources and transitions; it is not a timetable that everyone must follow. People of the same age may face different goals, opportunities and constraints. Begin with the actual context: what changed, which obligations are immediate, what resources remain and which decisions can wait? Some changes are anticipated, while others arrive suddenly. A short-term response may stabilise travel, income, time or care. It need not determine every longer-term choice, particularly while facts remain uncertain or important options need checking.

Longer-term adaptation may involve training, different hours, relocation, new networks or revised financial plans. Compare options using cost, reliability, wellbeing, pathway goals and effects on other people. A trade-off means gaining a benefit while reducing another; a contingency provides an alternative if the preferred plan fails. Support networks and services may expand choices, but check current availability and eligibility before relying on them. Set a review point to examine whether the plan meets work, financial, relationship and wellbeing needs and whether evidence changes the comparison. Otherwise a temporary fix can become an unsuitable default. Adaptive planning keeps a meaningful purpose while allowing the route to change; it does not treat one inconvenience as proof that the entire goal must be abandoned.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| life stage | a period shaped by a person’s current roles, responsibilities, resources and transitions |
| adaptation | a change to behaviour or planning in response to new conditions |

### Worked example: Adapting after a transport change

Ben's evening transport ends, making his shift difficult while he completes training. He checks the roster and transport facts before reacting. A lift, a shift discussion or temporary travel spending might stabilise the immediate situation.

A different timetable or rearranged training hours could be longer-term options. He compares cost, reliability, effects on others and pathway goals, then sets a two-week review. The change calls for tested alternatives, rather than automatically abandoning work or training.

**Apply the idea: Compare a lift and temporary travel spending for Ben: identify one trade-off for each. Recommend one immediate check and one piece of evidence to examine at his two-week review before continuing.**

YEAR 12 / MANAGING WORK AND LIFE COMMITMENTS

# Explain and check

Begin each source response below. Develop each into a 120–180-word explanation in your class folio, labelled with the reading title. Use the reading, its example and verified teacher-provided evidence where the prompt requires investigation.

**1. Evaluate a fictional worker-student's weekly commitments and redesign the plan to be realistic and sustainable.**

**2. Evaluate a fictional wellbeing case and justify a layered support response.**

**3. Evaluate three responses to a major life-stage change and recommend a reviewable work–life plan.**

**Quick check: Which boundary is communicated most effectively?**

- ○ A. Whatever, I might do it
- ○ B. Say yes and disappear
- ○ C. Blame an unrelated colleague
- ○ D. I cannot complete both by Friday; I can deliver the urgent part Friday and the remainder Monday—can we confirm priorities?

YEAR 12 / PERSONAL FINANCE

# Pay, tax, superannuation and records

A pay slip records a particular pay period. It commonly identifies the employer, employee, payment date, hours, rates, deductions, gross and net amounts, and superannuation information. Gross pay is earnings before deductions; net pay is what remains after authorised deductions such as tax withholding. Employer superannuation information is a separate field to inspect, rather than a reason to assume that every contribution comes out of net pay. Comparing a deposit only with gross earnings can therefore create a false impression of missing money. Year-to-date figures show cumulative earnings and withholding, helping a worker connect this period with earlier records.

Checking starts by matching dates: which shifts belong in this pay period? Compare the roster and hours record with listed hours and rates, then identify deductions and compare calculated net pay with the deposit. Preserve inconsistent records and raise a factual question through the employer's confirmed enquiry process; a difference is not automatically wrongdoing. Pay slips, contracts, time records and official correspondence provide evidence for later checks. Current tax and superannuation information comes from the Australian Taxation Office, while the Fair Work Ombudsman provides guidance about pay slips and workplace records. Rules and procedures can change, so this fictional classroom exercise is not a current entitlement calculation or personal financial advice. Use fictional or fully de-identified records to protect privacy.

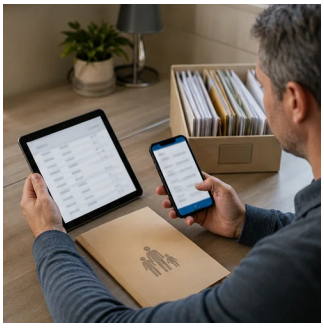


Figure 9. Source illustration. Records can be compared across devices. Use fictional or de-identified data, not personal financial information.

### Worked example: Checking a fictional pay slip

Noah's fictional pay slip lists 18 ordinary hours at $24 an hour: 18 × $24 = $432 gross. Tax is deducted, so his net deposit is lower. His hours record shows 20 hours, but two may belong to the next pay period. He first matches shift dates, then checks deductions. If hours within this period remain missing, he preserves copies and uses the confirmed employer enquiry process. The example rate does not establish a legal entitlement.

**Apply the idea: Audit Noah's printed example: record one confirmed calculation, one unresolved question about the two hours, and one privacy-safe next step. Explain why a lower net deposit alone does not prove an error.**

YEAR 12 / PERSONAL FINANCE

# Budgeting, banking, credit and saving

A budget plans money over a defined period; cash flow tracks when money arrives and leaves. A monthly surplus cannot pay a bill due before the next income arrives. List income by amount, timing and reliability, then distinguish fixed commitments, variable spending and irregular expenses. Needs and wants depend on circumstances: travel may be essential for work rather than an optional treat. A sinking fund sets aside smaller regular amounts for a known future cost. Alongside a specific savings purpose and a buffer, it helps prevent predictable expenses from becoming surprises. Record actual spending so the plan can be tested.

A variance is the difference between planned and actual amounts. Investigate why it occurred before changing the plan: an estimate, an unusual event or a new priority may explain it. A useful revision might reduce a flexible cost, change timing or adjust a goal while protecting essential commitments. Banking and credit comparisons also require the whole picture: fees, interest, repayment timing, access, security and missed-payment consequences. Borrowing commits future income, so test affordability across the repayment period and a plausible setback. Use current provider terms and official information, rather than a headline offer. Strong unique authentication and independently verified provider contact channels reduce digital risk; urgency in an unexpected message does not prove it is genuine.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| cash flow | the timing and amount of money received and paid over a period |
| fixed expense | a cost that is regular and usually predictable for the planning period |

### Worked example: Repairing a lumpy monthly budget

Aisha receives reliable fortnightly income, pays weekly transport costs and faces an annual registration expense in three months. Her budget shows a monthly surplus but no registration provision. She creates a sinking fund after each pay, maps bill dates and keeps a buffer. Higher-than-planned dining costs become a variance to investigate, not proof of failure. Regular spending review helps her revise the plan
instead of assuming a positive monthly total makes high-cost borrowing affordable.

**Apply the idea: Using Aisha's example, name the timing problem, propose one regular action for registration, and identify one flexible cost to review. Explain why a monthly surplus is insufficient evidence of affordability.**

YEAR 12 / PERSONAL FINANCE

# Consumer decisions, risk and future planning

Start a consumer decision with the goal, timeframe, available resources and constraints. Purchase price is only part of total cost: fees, interest, maintenance, replacement risk and cancellation conditions may change the comparison. Opportunity cost is what another use of the same money or time would offer. Advertising combines checkable claims, limiting conditions and emotional persuasion; enthusiasm does not prove value. Saving usually prioritises access and lower short-term risk for near goals, whereas investing accepts possible loss in pursuit of longer-term growth. Insurance transfers specified risks under a contract; it does not remove every possible loss or guarantee that every claim is covered.

A suitable comparison considers time horizon, fees, liquidity and risk tolerance. Liquidity means access to funds when needed; an option may be unsuitable if money is required before its intended horizon. Diversification reduces reliance on one asset, provider or risk source, but cannot guarantee against loss. Future planning must also consider inflation, changed income and major life events. Test a plausible setback, such as reduced hours, increased costs or poor performance, rather than only the best case. Urgency, secrecy and promised certainty are warning signs demanding independent verification. Protect personal information and check current provider documents and official consumer guidance. These classroom principles support reasoning; they cannot determine an individual's choice, which may require appropriately qualified advice.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| opportunity cost | the value of the next-best option given up when a choice is made |
| liquidity | how readily an asset can be converted to usable money without major loss |

### Worked example: Comparing transport choices

Luca needs reliable transport for a six-month training placement. He compares a used bicycle, public transport and a financed used car advertised at a low weekly repayment. First he defines route, reliability, timeframe and available cash. He then considers fares, purchase cost, maintenance, relevant insurance, fees, total repayments and flexibility. A reduced-hours test reveals whether future commitments remain manageable. The headline repayment cannot establish the car's total cost or suitability; current terms still need checking.

**Apply the idea: For Luca, identify two costs beyond the car's advertised weekly repayment and one reduced-hours risk. State one condition that must be checked before preferring any of the three transport options.**

YEAR 12 / PERSONAL FINANCE

# Explain and check

Begin each source response below. Develop each into a 120–180-word explanation in your class folio, labelled with the reading title. Use the reading, its example and verified teacher-provided evidence where the prompt requires investigation.

**1. Evaluate a fictional pay-record discrepancy and recommend an evidence-based sequence for checking and raising it.**

**2. Evaluate a fictional young worker's cash-flow plan after an irregular expense and a reduction in hours, then recommend a sustainable revision.**

**3. Evaluate three fictional financial options for a defined life-planning goal and make a conditional, evidence-based recommendation.**

**Quick check: How should a budget variance be used?**

- ○ A. Treat any difference as personal failure
- ○ B. Change every goal immediately
- ○ C. Investigate its cause and use the evidence to improve the next plan
- ○ D. Delete the actual spending record

YEAR 12 / FICTIONAL FINANCE LAB

# Cash flow across three pay cycles

A positive total can hide a timing problem. Cash flow follows when money arrives and leaves. A sinking fund reserves regular amounts for an irregular bill; an available buffer can absorb a setback. Compare the plan with actual spending and revise it before relying on credit.

## Worked cycle 1: separate teaching data

Fictional three-cycle practice: opening available cash is $0. Net income is $480 in cycles 1 and 2, falling to $360 in cycle 3. Each cycle reserves $90 transport, $180 living costs, $60 saving and $60 for an irregular $180 bill due after cycle 3. Transfers into saving and the bill fund are separate from available cash. No tax, interest or legal rate is assumed.

Cycle 1 outflow = $90 + $180 + $60 + $60 = $390. Available-cash change = $480 − $390 = $90; closing available cash = $0 + $90 = $90. The bill fund contains $60, and saving contains $60.

| Cycle | Opening available cash | Net income | Planned outflow | Closing available cash |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | $0 | $480 | $390 | $90 |
| 2 | | $480 | $390 | |
| 3 | | $360 | $390 | |

| At end of cycle 3 | Your calculation |
|---|---|
| Irregular-bill fund total | |
| Separate saving total | |

**Explain how the lower third income affects cash flow and whether the irregular bill is funded. Recommend one realistic adjustment and its trade-off without inventing a credit cost.**

All dollar values are fictional classroom data. They are not personal financial advice or current pay, tax, credit or superannuation entitlements.

YEAR 12 / WORKPLACE ISSUES

# Recognising workplace issues

A workplace issue affects how work is organised, experienced or regulated and may require judgement or action. Workplace relations, equity, performance appraisal, leaving an employer and unemployment are examples. Changes in technology, work location, employment arrangements, safety and inclusion can also create issues. Repeating a claim does not establish it: identify the event, evidence, expectations and people affected. Separate a incident from the issue behind it. A roster change, for example, may involve communication, operational needs and unequal barriers, rather than simply proving that one group is wrong. Equity considers relevant differences and fair access, not only identical treatment.

Analyse effects at several levels. An individual may experience unclear duties or exclusion; a team may face workload or communication problems; an organisation may confront unsafe systems or restructuring; an industry may face automation, skills shortages or declining demand. One event can affect these levels differently. Distinguishing underlying conditions from individual behaviour prevents a system problem being reduced to personal blame, or a disagreement being exaggerated into an industry trend. Old examples are learning prompts, not current legal instructions. Use authoritative information and confirmed workplace policies for rules, reporting contacts, representation or complaint pathways. Ask a teacher or trusted adult for help locating them. Fictional or de-identified cases should contain only information needed for analysis, avoiding names and unestablished allegations.

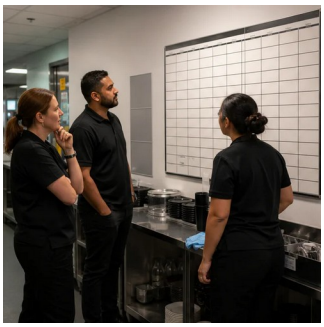


Figure 10. Source illustration. A roster discussion can reveal different perspectives. A photograph cannot establish the cause or legality of an issue.

### Worked example: Recognising the issue behind a roster change

A retail team receives a roster with less notice than usual. Two workers report caring difficulties; the manager says customer demand explains the change. Neither 'bad management' nor 'resistance to change' is an established conclusion. Analyse what changed, the evidence for demand, caring impacts, fairness and communication. Then check current rules, policies and possible consultation or adjustments. The immediate roster event raises a wider issue about how operational needs and workers' different circumstances are managed.

**Apply the idea: In the retail example, distinguish the observable event from one possible workplace issue. Identify two affected stakeholders and one piece of current evidence needed before judging whether the arrangement is fair.**

YEAR 12 / WORKPLACE ISSUES

# Analysing impacts, evidence and perspectives

Issue analysis asks what is claimed and how the evidence supports it. A confirmed policy describes what should happen, not necessarily what happened; a dated record can establish an event; one person's account reveals experience but may not explain a whole pattern. Aggregated data can show scale without proving every cause. Consider authority, currency, relevance, corroboration, limitations and possible bias together. Corroboration means additional independent or consistent evidence that strengthens or qualifies a claim, rather than repetition of the same rumour. A projected benefit remains a forecast until observations or results show what occurred. Certainty should match the quality and extent of evidence.

Stakeholders bring different responsibilities, information, values and risks. Employers may focus on continuity and costs, workers on workload and security, customers on access, and representatives on fair process. Explaining a perspective does not make its claims equally accurate or ethically acceptable. Test each against evidence, current obligations and effects on others. Follow impacts across individual, team, organisational and community levels and over time. Technology may improve speed while creating training needs, privacy concerns or unequal access; these costs may fall on different people from those receiving benefits. Identify intended outcomes and unintended consequences, including who carries each risk. A balanced finding weighs evidence and distributed impacts, rather than averaging opinions or automatically favouring the most powerful stakeholder.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| corroboration | support for a claim from additional independent or consistent evidence |
| perspective | a viewpoint shaped by a stakeholder's role, information, experience, risks and values |

### Worked example: Analysing a digital monitoring proposal

A service business proposes software recording task completion and location during work. Management expects better scheduling; workers raise privacy, trust and workload concerns. Check purpose, data collected, access, accuracy and current guidance. Efficiency is a projected benefit, not a measured result. Management, workers, customers and technology staff face different risks. A limited trial could be supported conditionally only with clear consultation, data boundaries, training, review indicators and a way to respond to errors.

**Apply the idea: For the monitoring proposal, distinguish one forecast from one concern. Identify an evidence check and explain one condition needed for a trial recommendation, including which stakeholder the condition would protect.**

YEAR 12 / WORKPLACE ISSUES

# Responding through policy, support and action

A response must match urgency, potential harm and evidence. Immediate danger requires the current workplace safety or emergency process; a less urgent concern may begin with clarification, factual documentation or a supported conversation. Proportionate action avoids escalation beyond the evidence while recognising that delay can cause harm when risk is serious. Exact contacts, complaint routes and procedures are workplace-specific. Use confirmed processes and authoritative guidance, asking a teacher or trusted adult for help locating them. Informal advice is not a binding decision. Supports have different roles, so select help according to what needs to be understood, communicated or decided.

A supervisor or designated contact may clarify duties or apply policy. A support person or representative may help prepare and communicate a concern within their permitted role; associations or authoritative external bodies may provide relevant current information or formal avenues. A defensible plan records observable facts, dates and communications, separating them from interpretation. State the desired outcome, choose a confirmed private channel and share only information required for that purpose. Then set a review point. A published policy alone does not prove that it is accessible, understood or applied. Review both the process used and whether the concern improved. New evidence, unresolved harm or increasing risk may require a revised response through a confirmed route rather than an invented next step.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| proportionate response | action matched to the seriousness, urgency, evidence and potential harm of an issue |
| representation | support or advocacy provided by an authorised person or body for a stakeholder |

### Worked example: Responding to repeated task exclusion

Priya is repeatedly excluded from equipment training offered to other new workers. She has dates and messages but does not know why. She records the pattern without alleging a motive, checks training and equity expectations, and identifies the confirmed contact. Her enquiry explains the effect on her duties and requests clarification and an equitable training plan. An appropriate support person may help. She protects colleagues' privacy and sets a review point, checking current guidance if another avenue becomes necessary.

**Apply the idea: For Priya, write one factual case-note sentence and one desired outcome. Identify a proportionate first action and a review check, avoiding an assumed motive or an invented complaint contact or process.**

YEAR 12 / WORKPLACE ISSUES

# Explain and check

Begin each source response below. Develop each into a 120–180-word explanation in your class folio, labelled with the reading title. Use the reading, its example and verified teacher-provided evidence where the prompt requires investigation.

**1. Evaluate a fictional contemporary workplace issue by distinguishing the incident, stakeholders, structural influences and information needed for a sound conclusion.**

**2. Evaluate a proposed workplace change using source quality, stakeholder perspectives and distributed impacts, then reach a conditional judgement.**

**3. Design and justify a proportionate response plan for a complex fictional workplace issue with uncertain evidence and competing stakeholder needs.**

**Quick check: How can policy and practice be compared?**

- ○ A. Check both the stated process and evidence of how it was applied and what changed
- ○ B. Assume publication proves compliance
- ○ C. Ignore the written expectations
- ○ D. Measure only how quickly a document opens

YEAR 12 / SELF-EMPLOYMENT

# From strengths and needs to a viable idea

Self-employment involves creating and managing work, rather than receiving every task, system and customer from an employer. Initiative, communication, persistence, organisation and problem-solving can help, but no personality stereotype or strength guarantees success. Capabilities can be developed or combined with other people's expertise at a manageable scale. Begin an idea with a defined need: who needs a task completed, a problem reduced, an improved experience or easier access? A value proposition connects that customer group with a useful outcome and a credible reason to choose the approach. Features the creator likes matter only if they serve the customer's need.

Demand requires evidence, not just friends' praise. Ethical observation, de-identified interviews, competitor analysis, prototypes or a test of willingness to engage can reveal how people currently meet the need. A feasibility study asks whether the idea can work within available time, skills, resources, costs, location and risk. Estimate demand and costs conservatively, investigate alternatives and identify assumptions that might disprove the idea. Personal fit matters alongside market viability: possible income does not make excessive hours, physical demands or unsuitable customer contact sustainable. Keep classroom ideas hypothetical or within teacher approval. Planning does not authorise trading, gathering personal data or approaching businesses. A bounded, approved test may support proceeding, revising or stopping, while safety and liability questions require current authoritative guidance.



Figure 11. Source illustration. A repair idea connects skills with a possible need. Demand, costs, permission and capability still require evidence.

### Worked example: Testing a school-community repair idea

Eli enjoys bicycle maintenance and proposes low-cost weekend safety checks for local students. Friends like the idea, but demand and operating conditions are unconfirmed. He defines the customer and limited outcome, uses a teacher-approved anonymous survey and competitor scan, and lists resources, costs and time assumptions. Skills gaps may require supervision or training; safety and liability need current authoritative advice. This remains a feasibility study until an authorised next step, rather than permission to perform checks or trade.

**Apply the idea: For Eli's idea, write a one-sentence value proposition, identify one assumption needing a demand test, and name one capability or safety question. Keep the proposed next step hypothetical or teacher-approved.**

YEAR 12 / SELF-EMPLOYMENT

# Business models, obligations and risk

A business model explains how an activity creates value, reaches customers, uses resources and receives revenue while meeting costs. A business structure is its legal and administrative form. Sole trader, partnership, company and trust are common Australian structures; contracting and franchising describe other ways work may be organised, rather than interchangeable structure labels. Compare ownership, decision control, responsibility, liability, tax, reporting and setup before assuming a form suits an idea. No structure automatically guarantees customers or success. Operating obligations depend on the activity, location, structure and whether others are engaged, so a classroom comparison can identify questions without settling an individual's legal or tax choices.

Potential requirements include registrations, licences, records, consumer obligations, contracts, intellectual property, privacy, insurance, employment and work health and safety. Check current Australian Government, state or territory, local and industry guidance, with qualified advice where needed. Risk management identifies what could prevent the goal or cause harm, then assesses likelihood, consequence and existing controls. Financial risks include cash shortages; operational risks include equipment or supply failure; people risks include capability and safety; reputational risks include unmet promises. Responses may avoid, reduce, transfer or accept risk, but a control can add cost or create another exposure. Residual risk remains after controls. Monitor it against a clear tolerance and review point; planning does not authorise establishing an enterprise.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| business model | the logic by which an activity creates and delivers value, receives revenue and meets costs |
| business structure | the legal and administrative form through which a business operates |

### Worked example: Choosing a structure for a fictional design service

Two graduates propose small digital-design jobs. They compare operating separately, a partnership and a company, but ownership and decision rights remain undefined. They examine control, ownership of work and equipment, income and losses, personal liability, administration, disagreement and exit. Current business.gov.au and ATO guidance supports the comparison; legal and accounting questions require qualified advice. Any provisional preference remains conditional on their needs and confirmed requirements. Analysing structures does not establish or register their business.

**Apply the idea: For the graduates, identify two ownership or decision questions that must be clarified. Name one operational risk, a possible control and the residual uncertainty, without choosing a structure as universally best.**

YEAR 12 / SELF-EMPLOYMENT

# Planning, communicating and reviewing a micro-enterprise

A business plan is a decision tool connecting a need and value proposition with customer evidence, operations, resources, roles, timing, costs, revenue assumptions and risk. Make assumptions visible so they can be tested. A sales forecast predicts possible demand; it is not income already earned. Revenue is not profit, because relevant costs must be met, and cash timing affects sustainability. A small bounded test can supply stronger evidence than an ambitious unsupported forecast. Communication creates expectations through a name, message, image and channel. Its claims should be accurate, appropriate to the audience and consistent with what can be delivered.

Ethical marketing explains benefits and conditions without invented testimonials, hidden costs or pressure exploiting vulnerability. Accessibility, privacy and cultural respect affect who can understand and respond. School identity, public platforms, personal data and external customer contact require explicit approval and confirmed conditions. Review should compare the plan with indicators: financial evidence such as revenue, costs and cash timing; customer enquiries, use and feedback; operational time, quality and rework; and personal workload and wellbeing. A decision gate asks whether evidence supports continuing, revising, pausing or stopping. Explain variances, identify uncertainty and choose a justified next test or closure action. Stopping a weak idea protects resources and shows judgement; a detailed plan never guarantees success or removes the need to review results.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| revenue | money received from business activity before expenses are subtracted |
| profit | the amount remaining when relevant business expenses are subtracted from revenue |

### Worked example: Reviewing a prototype tutoring offer

Sienna designs a fictional small-group study-skills service, assuming ten customers weekly. A teacher-approved expression-of-interest test produces three responses and requests for shorter sessions. Responses are evidence of interest, not completed sales. She recalculates the time and cost scenario for three customers, checks whether shorter sessions still deliver value, and revises the message for one bounded second test. She does not invent testimonials or launch publicly. The gate compares demand, quality, costs and workload before the next decision.

**Apply the idea: Compare Sienna's ten-customer assumption with the three responses. Explain why interest is not revenue, propose one justified revision, and choose one non-financial indicator to check before the next gate decision.**

YEAR 12 / SELF-EMPLOYMENT

# Explain and check

Begin each source response below. Develop each into a 120–180-word explanation in your class folio, labelled with the reading title. Use the reading, its example and verified teacher-provided evidence where the prompt requires investigation.

**1. Evaluate the viability and personal fit of a proposed micro-enterprise idea, then recommend proceeding, revising or stopping.**

**2. Evaluate three possible structures for a fictional micro-enterprise and recommend a provisional fit alongside a risk-management and verification plan.**

**3. Evaluate a hypothetical micro-enterprise after its first bounded test and recommend whether it should continue, revise, pause or stop.**

**Quick check: Which evidence most directly tests demand for a proposed service?**

- ○ A. The creator's confidence
- ○ B. Compliments from unrelated friends
- ○ C. The number of colours in the logo
- ○ D. A small ethical test of whether the defined customers will take a meaningful next step

YEAR 12 / EXPERIENCING WORK

# Preparing for workplace experience

Workplace experience can connect classroom learning with real roles, relationships and expectations, but it is not automatically authorised by this workbook. School placement processes and host arrangements must confirm approvals, documentation, supervision, travel, accessibility, emergency and communication requirements. Do not contact a host, attend or perform tasks on the basis of classroom preparation. Within confirmed arrangements, investigate the organisation's purpose, customers or community, environment, roles and communication. Set observable learning goals, such as identifying approved examples of how priorities are communicated. Readiness may include punctuality planning, transport, suitable communication and questions for induction; dress, equipment and conduct requirements must be confirmed rather than guessed.

Safety concepts help frame questions, not invent workplace procedures. A hazard has potential to cause harm; risk concerns the likelihood and consequence of that harm; a control eliminates a hazard or reduces its risk. Site-specific hazards, permitted tasks, protective equipment, training, emergency actions and reporting paths come from current induction and authorised supervision. A familiar-looking task is not automatically safe or permitted. If uncertain, untrained or concerned about danger, pause and seek direction through the confirmed process. Induction also clarifies privacy, breaks, accessibility and who may give instructions. A planning-only simulation can develop good questions without pretending a placement exists. Its purpose is readiness for learning while preserving every school and host authority boundary.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| workplace experience | an authorised learning experience in a real work setting under confirmed school and host arrangements |
| induction | workplace-specific introduction to roles, expectations, hazards, controls, procedures and support |

### Worked example: Preparing for a hypothetical library placement

Tahlia may undertake public-library experience, subject to school and host confirmation. She assumes it is only shelving. Researching the library's purpose and possible teams leads to goals about customer communication and task priorities. She prepares questions about induction, permitted tasks, manual handling, privacy, emergencies, breaks, accessibility and who gives instructions. She neither decides shelving is safe nor selects equipment or contacts the library independently. School and host arrangements must confirm every participation detail and control first.

**Apply the idea: For Tahlia's planning-only simulation, write one observable learning goal and two induction questions. Explain which school or host confirmation is still needed and why reading about shelving does not authorise participation.**

YEAR 12 / EXPERIENCING WORK

# Observe, participate and record evidence

Authorised placement participation is bounded by induction, permitted tasks, training, controls and supervision. Watching a worker does not authorise doing their task; permission for one task does not authorise another or independent repetition. Professional conduct includes punctuality, respect, listening, asking when uncertain and staying within role. Expectations and contacts come from confirmed school and host processes, with workplace induction and authorised supervision controlling actions on site. Observation, participation and evidence collection are separate permissions. Photographs, screenshots, documents, names, customer information and systems must not be captured or copied unless explicitly authorised. Evidence should show learning without exposing unnecessary information.

An objective learning record distinguishes observable events from opinions. It can note the date or stage, approved task or observation, role, action, attributed feedback and learning, using only necessary details. A diagram, de-identified note or teacher-provided template may communicate the learning more safely than copying an artefact. Feedback compares performance with expectations, rather than judging personal worth. Listen, paraphrase, clarify the message and identify a next observable action; after trying it within permission, check whether performance improved. One comment may reflect a single context. If feedback or an instruction conflicts with induction, safety or role boundaries, pause and seek clarification through the confirmed supervisor. Do not follow conflicting directions blindly or treat a photograph as proof of authorisation.



Figure 12. Source illustration. Observation, participation and recording are separate permissions. The image does not certify an approved placement or skill.

### Worked example: Recording an authorised customer-service observation

During a hypothetical approved placement, Jay watches a supervisor handle a customer query, then performs a permitted greeting. He wants a screen photograph as evidence, but it may expose customer or business information. Instead, he records a de-identified communication purpose, two observed techniques, his authorised task, feedback and the next behaviour to practise. He confirms evidence requirements through school and host processes. Permission to observe or greet does not include permission to capture workplace screens.

**Apply the idea: For Jay, separate observation, permitted participation and proposed evidence capture. Write one privacy-safe learning-log sentence using only supplied facts, then identify the permission still needed before any screen photograph is taken.**

YEAR 12 / EXPERIENCING WORK

# Reflecting, transferring learning and planning next steps

Reflection explains what an experience means, rather than simply listing events. Identify the situation and goal, authorised action or observation, result or feedback, learning and a future change. Useful evidence can come from positive and difficult moments; honesty matters more than appearing perfect. An approved simulation can support reflection if no placement occurred, but must be identified honestly. Transfer turns an example into a capability claim: name the skill, describe the context, explain your action and result, and show where it could apply. A general claim about excellence is weaker than an example with a link to another setting.

Similarities and differences both matter. Library task-prioritisation may support hospitality work, but customers, hazards, systems and supervision differ. Evidence for a resume, interview or pathway conversation must remain within privacy and approval boundaries.
Next-step planning combines self-knowledge with research into education, training, employment, volunteering or further experience. Compare options against goals, demonstrated capabilities, gaps, resources and commitments. A capability gap is a requirement not yet demonstrated, rather than a judgement of personal worth; a learning action or further information may address it. Check provider or official entry requirements and opportunities, or state that confirmation remains necessary. A reviewable plan names an action, support, progress evidence, contingency and reconsideration date. One experience informs a choice but cannot determine a career for life.

| Terms in this context | Meaning |
|---|---|
| reflection | evidence-based consideration of what occurred, what was learned and how future action may change |
| transferable evidence | a specific example that can support a capability claim in another relevant context |

### Worked example: Turning feedback into a pathway step

In a hypothetical approved placement, Amara receives praise for calm customer communication and advice to make task updates more concise. She is considering community-services training. She drafts evidence about clarifying a customer's need, sets a concise-handover goal and checks authoritative pathway requirements. She distinguishes transferable communication from unknown role-specific capabilities and plans an information check plus practice. Her next step depends on verified entry information and feasibility; one experience cannot prove a permanent career choice.

**Apply the idea: For Amara, identify one evidenced strength and one growth goal. Explain how communication may transfer to training while naming one context limit and one pathway fact that still needs authoritative confirmation.**

YEAR 12 / EXPERIENCING WORK

# Explain and check

Begin each source response below. Develop each into a 120–180-word explanation in your class folio, labelled with the reading title. Use the reading, its example and verified teacher-provided evidence where the prompt requires investigation.

**1. Apply the section’s planning criteria to build a preparation plan for a hypothetical workplace experience that maximises learning while preserving every approval, safety and privacy boundary.**

**2. Evaluate a hypothetical day of workplace experience and create a privacy-safe evidence record that distinguishes observation, authorised participation, feedback and unresolved questions.**

**3. Evaluate what a hypothetical or authorised workplace experience reveals about a student's capabilities and recommend a reviewable next-step pathway.**

**Quick check: Why should a workplace screen not be photographed by default?**

- ○ A. Screens never contain useful learning
- ○ B. Only printed documents are confidential
- ○ C. It may contain personal, commercial or system information and capture requires explicit permission
- ○ D. A student owns every image they take

YEAR 12 / WORK EXPERIENCE AND TRANSFER FOLIO

# Evidence without exposure

In the source's hypothetical approved placement, Jay observes a customer-service response and attempts a permitted greeting task. He does not photograph a screen containing possible customer or business information. A useful record separates observation, authorised participation, feedback and the next skill to practise. A workbook entry cannot certify attendance, competence or host approval.

| Fictional raw note | Privacy-safe rewrite / permission decision |
|---|---|
| "A customer's name and order were on the screen." | |
| "I watched the supervisor clarify a query." | |
| "I tried the greeting task I was permitted to attempt." | |
| "The supervisor suggested one clearer question." | |

**Write a de-identified learning record linking one observed technique, one authorised action, feedback and a next behaviour to practise. Record what the school or host must confirm before an artefact is collected.**

**Select one skill developed in this course. Explain where else it could transfer, which workbook evidence supports that claim and one realistic next learning step.**

Use fictional or de-identified information. Current teacher and host instructions control actual work-experience participation and evidence requirements.